

POEMS

— BY —

Thomas Hall Shastid,

— AUTHOR OF —

"Newspaper Ballads."

A Collection of Juvenile Poems, the Author Being
Fourteen Years of Age.

PITTSFIELD, ILLINOIS:
THE AUTHOR.
1881.

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PREFACE.

To my many friends who have been so lenient in their criticisms of my former work, and to the several editors and literary men who have given me so much encouragement, I wish to return my sincere thanks.

All the request I have to make, is, that I hope my efforts this time will receive no more condemnation than my other.

I take pleasure in launching my little volume upon the wide sea of literature. The author is fourteen years of age, but many of the poems were written at a much earlier age.

Yours, most respectfully,
THOMAS HALL SHASTID.



POEMS.

CHRISTMAS NIGHT.

BE peace on earth, good will to men;
And let this now our carol be:
If on the land, or on the sea,
We still will sing the glad refrain;
And in the closing light of day
Good words of peace and cheer will say.

The Babe that in the manger born
Has risen high above the star,
To judge in peace, or judge in war,
To judge at night or judge at morn.
The star that told us of his birth
Has given us joy and lasting mirth.

The Man that suffered on the tree
Is risen high above all men;
Then swell the glad refrain again—
He died for me, He died for thee:
Then peace be ever on the earth
To one and all of human birth.

FALLING OF THE APPLE TREE.

THE apple tree has fallen, now—
The axe has laid it low;
The blossoms sparkled ere it fell,
But now they wither so.

Its shade we now shall seek in vain—
The spot we loved so well
Has vanished since the apple tree
So loudly crashing fell.

No more the wind sings through the leaves,
The song so dear to me;
Ah! yes, that rustling far above
Was one of melody.

No more we see that staunch old tree—
The axe has laid it low,
And much we'll miss it, evermore,
That fall was one of woe.

THE ANGELS.

THE Angel of Peace flew over the land,
And the country was wild with glee;
And she stilled the wave in the stormy night
On a rolling and restless sea.

But the Angel of Death flew over the land
And a babe was taken that night.
And an angel sweet in heaven appeared
In the land of glory and light.

THE SPECTRES.

IN a palace sad and lonely
 Flit two spectres all the day—
Spectres chasing joy and brightness
 From each window far away.

One is Sorrow clad in raiment,
 Sombre as the shades of night,
While her trailing robes of darkness
 Chase away each ray of light.

But the other one is Envy
 Clad in blackness, clad with woe,
Sorrow's only sad companion,
 Flitting ever to and fro.

By the windows ever gliding,
 Filling all with thoughts of pain;
All who gaze are doomed forever,
 Ne'er to see bright joy again.

THE YEARS.

ALL around us, ever floating,
Silently yet swiftly on,
Pass the years in quick succession—
Years that are forever gone.

Years that soon are past recalling.
Years of gladness or of woe;
We can never stop their fleeting
But forever they will go.

Years of sorrow passing round us,
Dark and dreary as the night.
Years of gladness quickly follow
Bringing thoughts all fair and bright.

Still the years continue passing
Swiftly as the years can be,
Till we leave our pains and sorrow;
Till we find eternity.

MY THOUGHTS.

I WOULD I had some magic pen
That would my thoughts convey.
There were a mighty pen that would
The world astound to-day.

They come and go as fountains flow:
Unceasing, always flowing,
For while some thoughts are coming fast
The others fast are going.

BY THE FIRESIDE.

ON the bright red coals before me,
Pictures come and pictures go—
Pictures of the waiting future
Filled with gladness or with woe.

By the fireside do I picture
To myself my destiny.
Who knows but these golden raptures
May be real unto me.

Though the storm outside be raving
And the snowflakes drift on high;
By the fireside I am safely
Counting on what may be nigh.

All the flames fly ever upward
Coiling into every form.
Fairies circle ever round me
Heedless of the outside storm.

Still I watch the weird wild raptures
Of the golden dream so nigh.
Let us love our happy fancies
E'er the time has passed us by.

THE HAUNTED HOUSE.

SEE the grass upon its threshold;
See the ivy on its wall;
Vacant are its crumbling windows,
Vacant is its mossy hall.

Ah! the step of man upon it
Shall resound along no more,
For the spirits of the dead ones
Ever flit about the door.

There the whisperings of the voices
Of the spirits of the dead;
Those of friends and enemies
Ever murmur 'round your head.

Let us leave the haunted ruin;
Spirits walk the crumbling floor;
Light their step, but oh! their voices
Haunt the building evermore.



THE KINGDOM OF THE DEAD.

PEACEFUL be for we have reached it
Lighter, lighter ever tread,
'Tis a sacred spot and hallowed:
'Tis the kingdom of the dead.

Silent kingdom, sad and lonely,
Though so many in it dwell.
Who can number all its people?
Who, ah! who can ever tell?

Still and peaceful is their resting
In their last and humble bed.
Tread ye lightly, 'tis the kingdom
Of the sacred holy dead.

THE WIND.

HEAR ye not the howling wind,
Sad and wild?
In its wake come dismal fancies
Never mild.

Like the moaning of the lost
Comes the wind:
Moaning, sighing—viewless phantoms
Come behind.

In the darkness come the spirits
Of the night,
Howling, with their dismal groaning
In their flight.

Absent friends come in our fancies
Evermore,
As the demons flee from Hades
Rush and roar.

Hear ye not the moaning wind
Moan and quiver
Like the moaning of the lost—
Lost forever?

THE SONG OF THE WIND.

I.

OVER hill and over valley—
Over meadows rich and green,
Playing with the summer grasses—
Fairer sights were never seen.

Not a mortal ever saw me,
Though I see THEM ev'ry day;
Passing like a viewless spirit
On my happy singing way.

Often do I rise up skyward,
Chasing fast the cloudlets there,
And I drive them headlong onward
Till they all in fragments tear.

Often on the field of battle,
'Mid the storm that works them woe,
Do I cheer 'mid cannon's rattle,
Kissing both the friend and foe.

And the wounded, as he listens
To me as I whistle on,
Thinks of home and friends and parents
And of days that now have gone.

I often whistle through the woods
And toss the hunter's hair.
He sits him down upon a log,
While I caress him there.

His brow with sweat is covered o'er—
He feels my cooling sway,
I toss about his silver locks;
That deck his head of gray.

But on I go until I find
The

The farmer in his field;
I whistle o'er his garnered store
The willing land doth yield.

He hails me as his merry friend,
And thus I am to him;
I never pass without I cheer
His features calm and grim.

I cheer the poet as he sings
Beside some flowing stream,
And looks upon the dim, dim past,
A vision or a dream.

II.

He hails me, as I sail along,
In accents clear and free.
I answer in an unknown tongue
And pass on cheerily.

He knows me well, and loves me too—
He watches till I find
His resting place where he may leave
All earthly cares behind.

I visit oft where lovers sit,
I hear their vows of love;
The bright green grass is all below—
The sky of blue above.

And there they sit and talk of love—
As only lovers know;—
They think the world a paradise
And all things bright below.

III.

I visit oft the city's haunts,—
I raise the dust on high,
And whirl it like a water-wheel,
As ever on I fly.

I play with wigs and hats and cloaks,
And whistle by the house—
Then to a gentle zephyr turn,—
As quiet as a mouse.

Then breaking in an angry fit,
I whistle by the bell
That hangs within the steeple tall—
And sound a faint, low knell.

By ruins old I make my way—
I tear the ivy vines,
And fill with dust and sand and dirt
The ancient sculptured lines.

IV.

I ramble on the deep, dark sea,
And toss those waves of blue;
I scare the boasting mariner
And tear the sails in two.

The clouds that hang far overhead
Are dropping to the sea,
The waves as mountains now become—
I roar out in my glee.

The captain stands with face aghast—
With terror in his eyes—
The fork-ed lightning strikes its wings
That waft it from the skies.

The thunder stops, the clouds pass by,
The waves are resting now;
The gallant ship before my breath
With magic speed doth plow.

V.

Ye frightened goodly mariners,
That angels were before—
The storm has quit, you curse again,
You're sinners wild once more.

And when the next storm rocks the ship,
And the thunders roll and roar,
You drop upon your knees again—
Art sainted then once more.

I cross the sea, and soon I find
Europa's golden coast—
The Spanish pride;—the English tar
Makes well his frequent boast.

VI.

I love the clime of Africa—
The dark man's native home;
I love that central, torrid zone
Wherever I may roam.

I also love the Northern pole—
Auroras glisten there—
I love the regions still and cold,
The icebergs standing bare.

The water trickling down their sides—
I waft them towards the south;
The walrus suns him as we go,
And opes his giant mouth.

I love to sway the trees in spring
When all in green they stand,—
In winter do I move their boughs
While roaming o'er the land.

Sometimes I frolic round about
Between the earth and sky;
And it is true where'er I go
A jolly one am I.

I love to whirl the storm around
And roar out ev'rywhere,
And superstitious people, too,
I often sadly scare.

I've seen fair Eden's leafy trees—
I've seen the first of man,
And I shall see the last of him—
I saw how he began.

I saw the star of Bethlehem—
I heard the angels sing;
I saw the manger and the Christ—
The great and goodly king.

I saw the Cæsar in his Rome—
Who raised her towers on high;
She raised those towers aloof from earth,
She rose, and but to die.

Then passing in the flight of years
I saw Napoleon's day;
I saw the time when he did rise,
And when he fell away.

I saw the hero, Washington,
Who for his country fought.
"I'll free my country from her bonds,"
That was his only thought.

I've known more things than history—
And if I brought to light,
These things 'twould make the stoutest heart
To start aback with fright.

I've witnessed murders never seen
By any human eye;
I've seen the very best of men
By violence to die.

I've touched the knife that did the deed;
I've kissed the brow in vain;
No sign of life upon the face,
So dark and black with pain.

I know of secrets never known
To any one but me.
I've seen when death had come at last
And set the captive free.

Then listen as I pass along
For aye and evermore,—
I sing my only song to you,
As I pass by your door.

IX.

Often have I sung this story,
When at midnight's solemn reign;
Like a ghost or howling demon
Will I sing it oft again.

I have lived through all the ages,
And will live for many more,
Blowing by the stormy ocean,
On the sea and on the shore.

On the shore or on the ocean—
Still a jolly friend am I,
Ne'er deserting, always constant,
As my zephyrs gently fly.

You will find me in the future
Just as I have always been—
Free from all unjust transgressions—
Free from any kind of sin.

Often do I waft the odors
From the fields of clover sweet;
When with breath of sweetest perfume,
Do I all the woodlands greet.

So good-bye; I must be speeding—
 Stirring up the Autumn leaves;
I must visit now the farmer
 As he binds his golden sheaves.

I must visit now the smithy
 And his anvil ringing clear,—
Even now his clanking irons
 Do I faintly seem to hear.

Now, adieu; I must be speeding
 Where the wild wings swiftly fly,
And the clouds go by me floating,
 So I bid you all “good-bye.”

HASTINGS.

OH, bright the day when England's crown
Came forth to crown the king;
And in the minds of those around
It seemed no trifling thing.

“Give back the crown!” was William's word,
“Or my good sword shall pay,
With heavy thrust and bleeding cut,
For this you've done to-day.”

For Edward's will that crown had sent
To grace stern William's head,
But Harold too had claimed the right,
And for that right he bled.

Aye! bled, and died, and lost the crown
He'd struggled so to save,
And ah! that struggle led him to
His solitary grave.

Yes! Godwin's son was born to fight—
To chase and not to fly,
And he was born for Hasting's fate,
And that fate was to die.

Ah! weep ye noble Saxon men—
The last king of your line
Shall sleep the cold, still sleep of death,
That solemn sleep divine.

To-day we merry are and joy
Doth reign supreme around,
And music seems in every noise
And ev'ry passing sound.

To-morrow comes—that joy is gone—

There lies the human clay,
The spirit to its rest has gone
Where brighter shines the day.

We know not when that bidding comes,
That bears us from the earth;
How few the years that stand between
Our death-call and our birth.

Thus was't with Harold—in the night,
Carousing in the tent,
His joy was great, but 'morrow's light,
His knee in suppliance bent.

The cup went round,—and small thought they
Upon the next day's fight,
That Harold soon in death should lie
Within the waning light.

In William's camp no cup went round,
But heads were bent in prayer,
And plans were laid; then silence kept
Its peaceful reigning there.

Oh! solemn was the prayer they said—
And solemn was the scene;
The archers with their bows stood by
With grave and silent mien.

The morning came,—the proud array
Stood silent as the dead;
The battle-axes in their hands
Did rise far overhead.

And in the midst, his armor bright,
Stood Harold with his sword,
And far and near around stood those
Who waited at his word.

WHO waited at his word.

The banner rose above them all—
Its warrior stood on high,
And precious stones did mark him there
That scarcely wealth could buy.

Duke William led his heroes forth
And gave them to the fray,
Ah, many of those heroes there
Ne'er saw another day.

The battle raged, and sunset came,
And flashed on armor bright,
And all around were mangled men—
It was an awful sight.

King Harold fell, the arrow pierced
And bore him to the ground;
Ah! then was heard a trampling noise—
A wildly flying sound.

The warrior and the banner fell,
And dyed were they in blood
No more the Saxon's sang their shout:
“God's rood! aye, holy rood!”

THE TEMPERANCE SHIP.

DRIFTING down the tide we go?
Nay! we hoist the sail;
Speeding fast and faster still
With the blowing gale.

Come sign the pledge and get on board
And leave behind your woe,
For the sky is bright, and the gale is right,
As like the wind we go.

We sail between the shores of green,
On the waters shining breast;
Oh! sign the pledge and the ribbon don
And forever you'll find rest;

Sweet rest upon our temperance ship
And leave behind your woe;
For the sky is bright and the gale is right,
As like the wind we go.

THE HALL OF MEMORY.

THERE is a Hall of Memory
Within a happy land;
The walls are high and marble clear
With wealth on every hand.

The railings on the stairway
Are made of purest gold;
The marble steps below them
Are hard and stern and cold.

I love the Hall of Memory—
I love to linger there;
Sweet visions coming evermore,—
Its pictures bright and fair.

Its walls are decked with pictures
Made by a Masters hand;
The marble figures far and near
Alive they seem to stand.

But there is one fair picture
I love to gaze upon;
It is the picture of a time
That is forever gone.

There is a Hall of Memory,
Its walls are stern and high;
The treasures it contains for me
No wealth can ever buy.

PEACE.

THE cold moon-light is shining clear;
The tall trees shadows throw,
And all is spectral far and near
As far as eye can go.

A peaceful calm rests o'er the scene,
The clouds no longer fly.
The busy world is hushed and still—
Its cares have passed us by.

But when to-morrow's light has come,
Then comes the care and pain—
The strife and warfare of our lives
Is rushing on again.

But still the white clouds fleck the sky,
And Peace is reigning on;
But soon the beauty of the night
Will fade and fast be gone.

THE SUNSET LAND.

FAR in the west is the sunset land
Where flows a mighty river;
It flows right o'er the crimson clouds
And it follows the sun forever.

The stars come chasing through the sky,—
They chase and they twinkle and play,
And they love the clouds of the sunset land
That soon will be far away.

And the twilight jealous and sombre and sad
Comes down with his robes of gray,
And he chases the light of the sunset land
Far from the west away.

STANZAS.

WHEN the weary day at last
With its cares and strife is past;

When I lay me down to sleep,
While the angels vigils keep,

Comes an echo far away
Of the doings of the day.

Ere my weary eyelids close,
Ere my being seeks repose.

Comes a voice from far away:
“What hast thou performed this day?”

Yes the air is full of spirits,
Many does each man inherit.

But at night each one will say:
“What hast thou performed this day?”

Ere my weary eyelids close;
Ere I calmly seek repose,

Comes an echo far away:
“What hast thou performed this day?”

THE SHIPWRECK.

THE seagull screamed and flopped his wings
And hied him to his home;
The breakers dashed upon the shore—
Their crests were filled with foam.

The briny mounts were thrown on high
Where reeled a ship; the gale
Had shorn her of her masts, and torn
In shreds each flying sail.

Alas! a wail comes o'er the deep—
The ship is sinking fast—
The mighty mountains of the sea
Are aided by the blast.

'Tis morn again, the rosy morn
The storm at sea is o'er;
The elements are calm and still;
The wreck is on the shore.

Then take good care in future life,
While near the billows roll;—
Take care lest your own self be lost
By shipwreck of your soul.

Then never let the breakers roll
To overwhelm the bark within,
As in the world you sail around
The blackened sea of sin.

CLEOPATRA'S NEEDLES.

It was in Africa's torrid clime,
Two sisters stood alone,
And what they witnessed was a sight
To melt a heart of stone.

The English came and carried off
One sister, far away;
And now in London's haunts she stands
And sorrows all the day.

They took her from her native spot,
Where she was wont to stand,
And placed her in a foreign clime,
Within a foreign land.

Ah! how she feels, with other eyes
Than on bright Egypt's shore;—
She stands where she had never been—
To stand for evermore.

The others came with iron bonds,
Her sister, too, they brought,
To grace America's bright parks
Where pity ne'er was thought.

Ah! yes, in New York city's haunts
That sister is to be;
Between the two the waters lie—
A dark and stormy sea.

Ah! now when I to Egypt's plains
Do wend my careful way,
I'll seek the spot where once they stood,
And there respect I'll pay.

But, oh, the beauties will be gone—

The sisters are not there,
Insulted by a grosser race,
They stand where naught is fair.





SONNETS.



SONNETS.

WINTER.

THE snow is lying deep upon the ground,
And naught disturbs the quiet, bitter air
Except the distant jingling sleigh bells sound,
Which seems to banish from my heart all care.
The trees are barren of their waving leaves,
The limbs are swaying sadly to and fro;
It seems as though it for its verdure grieves,
As down it shakes the flakes of shining snow.
Oh, thou to me forever art a friend—
I would that you were for the whole year round,
And He on high those blessings by you send
That always in your bounteous lap are found;
And you and I would be as angels here
And sorrow never know nor ever shed a tear!

SUNSHINE.

THOU dancing sunbeams through the happy day
Dost cheer me on my onward path through life,
You show to me more clear my stumbling way
And lighter make my almost ceaseless strife.
Thou art to me a greater friend indeed,
Than others I have loved up to this hour;—
They are oft but a wildly growing weed—
But thou art like a shining summer flow'r.
The world could not exist if not for thee,
The Ice-King would possession then obtain;
The light and beauty from all things would flee,
And naught but lasting, dark'ning chaos reign.
But now we have the cheerful, glittering light
That keeps the universe alive and bright.



POEMS.

PAST AND PRESENT.

LET us now improve the present,
Waiting not for something more;
For the past is gone forever
And its troubles all are o'er.

Let us hope not in the future
Golden days will be at hand;
Try, keep trying, for that country,
In a fairer, better land.

Up, be doing in the present,
Waiting not for something more;
For the past is gone forever
And its troubles all are o'er.

Those who wait are ne'er receiving—
Those who act are always blest;
Up, be doing, still be acting,
This is not a time for rest.

Let us now improve the present,
Waiting not for something more;
For the past is gone forever
And its troubles all are o'er.

GONE TO REST.

LITTLE Ada now has gone
To that land above,
Where no trouble ever comes;
All is brightness, all is love.

Now an angel far away
In that land of light;
Cheer up, oh, afflicted ones,
She is gone where all is bright.

Father, cheer the grieving parents;
Help them now to bear the woe;
Pity us, thy simple children,
In this land so far below.

Angels carried her to heaven,
Clothed her in their robes of light;
She is gone, but not forever,
From the loving parents' sight.

Little Ada now has gone
To that land above,
Where no trouble ever comes,
All is brightness, all is love.

A DREAM.

ON the summit of a mountain
 Stood I in the twilight gray,
There were many standing with me
 In the closing light of day.

Two paths led out from the summit—
 One to lands so clear and bright,
And the other to a dark land
 Where reigned eternal night.

Many chose the road to darkness—
 Pathway leading down to hell;
Few there were that took the other—
 They that chose it, chose it well.

'Twas a dream I dreamed in slumber,
 But 'tis real every day;
Many take the downward path,
 Few that go the brighter way.

THE LAST DRINK.

AN old man entered a dram-shop,
He staggerd and stumbled in;
His face was as hard as granite,
His hair was light and thin.

The bar-keeper's daughter entered
In a dress of purest white,
And she looked as sweet as could be
In her nice new clothes that night.

The old man stopped, and reasoned,
For his own dear child he knew
Was shoeless and cold and ragged
And his wife was starving, too.

So the dime that lay in his pocket,
Bought bread for his wife that night,
And the old bar-keeper's daughter
Still dressed in her snowy white.

But soon ere the winter was over
The drunkard was drunkard no more,
And the wife and child were happy
As they never had been before.

IN SPRING TIME.

Oh, fresh from the woodland comes the breath—
The breath of the beautiful spring;
And the gentle zephyrs that float about
Scents from the meadow and forest bring.
And in every tree
A robin in glee
Is chanting a joyous melody.

Oh the sweet calm breath of beautiful spring—
And the azure sky is bright above,
And the warm sunshine makes the whole world glad
For every beam is a message of love.
And in every tree
The robin in glee
Is chanting a joyous melody.

The warm sun shines and the sweet flowers bloom,
But ah, the wild winds will be raving amain,
And the cold gray winter will ravish our joys—
The beauties of earth will be vanished again.
From every tree
The robin will flee
And fly to the South with his melody.

But let us enjoy these transient delights
And gaze on their beauty while linger they here.
Let us thank our dear Father such grandeur may come
While spring claims her place in every year;
And in every tree
A robin will be
Chanting a beautiful melody.

THE RAIN STORM.

THROUGH the din of patt'ring rain drops
Comes the thunder in the night,
While the bold electric flashes
Dazzle for a while the sight.

Patter, patter come the rain-drops
Streaming down the window-pane.
On the roof, unceasing, patter
Noisy little drops of rain.

All the stars have left and hidden
And the crescent is no more;—
When will come the day and sunshine
As it came in days of yore?

But the patter of the rain-drops
Music to my thoughts they make,
When the rumbling peals of thunder
Rhyme and even rhythm break.

May we thankful be for sunshine
May we thankful be for rain;—
Come again, oh patt'ring rain-drops,
With your music come again.





SOLFERINO.

A Poem of Six Stanzas in Blank Verse.



SOLFERINO.

I.

On Solferino's dizzy heights there grew
The bright green grass and here and there were seen
The golden hues of flow'rets shining fair,
The bright, warm sunshine sparkled on the world
And all the cloudlets of the azure sky
Dark shadows threw upon the happy scene.

II.

But on the crest of that tall cliff there frowned
The battered walls the battlements and tow'rs,
And in the castle Solferino's prince
Walked to and fro and 'round him stood his men.
And ere the heart had time to falter once
Was heard the deafening rolling cannon's roar.

III.

"The foe has come!" They flew to arms, and ere
The echoes quite had died away, they gave
Forth shot for shot and shout for shout.
Then was thy life-blood spilt! That day
Was one of woe to thee Sardinia!
Those lives have left forevermore this earth.

IV.

Then came the awful ravage of the fray:
The cannon's roar, the dying's groan, the sounds of war.
And ev'rywhere was blood—the verdure was
Beneath the hard foot trampled and the day
Turned dark beneath the reign of chaos wild.

V.

The Mincio's waters drifted toward the sea.
But ever on its bosom wild was borne
The life-blood of the soldier's in the fray.
Ah! red as blood its once clear waters were,
And on its banks the same dread curse prevailed.

VI.

Thus man shall slay and man shall die until
The time when his wild fury thus unchecked
Shall spend itself and once relapse away.
Oh! may man's conscience soon awake to learn
The wild disaster that his fury wrought.

POEMS.



THE TEMPEST.

THE cold gray mist crept o'er the shore,
And hung about the bay;
We saw the foaming of the surf
Within the twilight gray.

But through the twilight cold and still
We heard the hum from yonder town;
We saw the path around the hill
Come winding ever slowly down.

The wild wind rose as night came on,
We heard the waves beat on the shore;
The tempest wailed and moaned about
Above the distant roar.

Sad night, alas! was that to some
Who, on the dreary ocean wide
Heard far and near the tempest come—
The wailing winds on either side.

A dreadful night—a stormy night—
It swept the wrecks ashore;
It was a time—a dreadful sight—
Forgotten nevermore.

That night was one of woe, alas!
The wild wind whistled by;
And seemed to be as it did pass
Some struggling sailor's drowning cry.

THE PEACEFUL LAND.

FAR in the west is a peaceful land
Where the golden sunset fades away,
And fast as the twilight shadows come
The sunset bids farewell to day.

The snow white vapor in fragments flies,
And the gold-edged clouds near the sunset move;
But the twilight, dim and dark and gray,
Steals fast from sight this land of love.

The zephyrs stir and the soft leaves wave
And sigh for the loss of the sunset sky;
But even the beauties that shine in the west
Must ever fade till the glories die.

THE LONELY CITY.

IN the distance dim a valley lies
Where flows a deep dark river;
On the farther shore a city stands,
Where the tide flows on forever.

A cloud hangs o'er the city fair
By day in the valley yonder;
By night in the streets, devoid of light,
Wild phantoms ever wander.

No sound comes forth from the vacant domes
That gleam in the quiet air.
No living thing breaks the solitude—
But the phantoms wander there.

In the distance dim a valley lies
Where flows a rolling river,
But the phantoms wander by its side
As time flies by forever.

THE COURSE OF THE STREAM.

WHEN the sunset in the west
Gilds the landscape far and near
Wraps the sun within his shroud
Dies he on a glorious bier.

When the night falls o'er the land,
Comes the crescent from the sky;
Silence reigns upon the scene,
As the brooklet hurries by.

When the starlight cold and still
Falls upon the earth below—
Falls upon the church-yard hill,
By the saddened brooklets flow.

Slower come the drifting waters
Ceasing once their noisy glee.
As it passes by it sings on
In a plaintive melody.

Ghostly rise the marble spectres
O'er the beds of those who sleep;—
Ever in the night or day time
Still their solemn vigils keep.

When the sunrise in the east
Gilds the sky with flames of light,
Runs the brooklet fast to meet
With its waters ever bright.

Onward to the flowing river,
And its waters mingle there;
Oh! when shall they return again
To the brooklet shining fair?

THE STAR.

WHEN the Christ was born on earth,
Then wise men the star did guide,
Till with riches they appeared
By the great Messiah's side.

And the angels ever echoed
Songs of happiness again,
And a voice from heaven answered
PEACE ON EARTH GOOD WILL TO MEN.

Still the star whirled in its orbit
Round the sun of heat and light,—
Saw the earth in years advancing—
Watched her in her rapid flight.

When we slumber peacefully,—
When we think not what is near,
Still the star's light shineth ever
All its beams are bright and clear.

Thus forever, yet unceasing,—
Still it shineth as of yore,
And shall be a guide and helper
Through the ages evermore.



FINIS.



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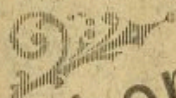
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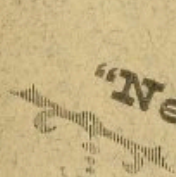
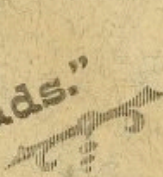
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